

GRAFT CRAFT

THE HINDU

CAUGHT RED-HANDED:
T.T. Krishnamachari
(centre)

<< REWIND



CARAVAN LEADER

Dismissed by M.A. Jinnah as a Muslim showboy and elevated by Nehru as the caravan leader, Maulana Abul Kalam Azad was crucial to the Congress in the early days of Partition when there was unease over minorities. Independent India's first education minister, who died in 1958 of a stroke, is still remembered as a permanent statement against the 'two nation' notion.



NEHRU MEMORIAL LIBRARY

For the first time, a financial scam rocked Independent India. Governmental corruption made headlines when Feroze Gandhi, MP from Rae Bareilly and husband of Indira Gandhi, brought to the notice of the Parliament an investment of Rs 1.24 crore by the newly nationalised Life Insurance Corporation in stock speculator Haridas Mundhra's sinking companies, calling it "a conspiracy to beguile the Corporation of its funds". Finance Minister T.T. Krishnamachari was forced to quit after the commission of inquiry headed by Justice M.C. Chagla found that his principal aide, Finance Secretary H.M. Patel, had ordered the deal. After his arrest, Mundhra, whom Feroze called the "mystery man of India's business underworld", revealed he had contributed to the Congress party coffers. The inquiry was intended to serve as a "corrective to administrators all over the country", but sadly, that was never to happen.

<< DID YOU KNOW

Filmmaker Ritwik Ghatak wrote the screenplay for Bimal Roy's famous reincarnation drama *Madhumati*, starring thespian Dilip Kumar and Vyjayanthimala.

FIRST CUT

• For the first time, two technical squadrons were added to the National Cadet Corps'

air wing.

• The Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act was passed by the Parliament.